

CASE STUDY RESEARCH

OBJECTIVE CONDITIONS

Researcher's Race, Class, Gender, Age, Ethnicity, and Nationality

Is the purpose of the research to thoroughly & comprehensively study a unit of analysis—a person, group, organization, event &/or process to generate a complete, well-organized picture of that unit?

NO

Select another research design

Identify the research problem/interest

preliminary review to clearly define research problem

literature Review

Research Problem

Describe the individual, group, organization, community, event &/or process that serves as the unit of analysis

Conduct a comprehensive literature review on similar topics/issues studied & theoretical & methodological approaches used

Arrange research historically, chronologically, & logically; Reveal & critically summarize the race, class, gender, ethnic, & generational biases at all stages of research reviewed—problem selection, theoretical framework, research design, conclusions & recommendations, aim of research (observed in how findings were used)

Clarify parameters of research study, clearly define unit of analysis, & revise research question/issue

Construct a plan of action: consider population, data collection design, sampling design, data analysis design, information & resource needs, available resources, and timeframe

Theoretical Frame

Link research question & hypothesis to body of theory

Hypothesis/Question

Generate clear and precise conceptual definitions of concepts & variables & how they will be observed/measured in the unit of analysis

MULTIDISCIPLINARY RESEARCH DESIGN:
Employ a variety of approaches to enable researcher to understand totality of the unit of analysis & the context within which it evolved over time/space

Archival	Ethnographic
Action Research	Evaluation
Comparative	Experimental
Content Analysis	Field Research
Curriculum Review	Historical
Documentary	Survey

Revise action plan to reflect allocation of responsibilities, revise timeframe, train research team, if necessary, etc.

Acquire/construct appropriate data collection & recording instruments

Gather data according to appropriate research methods & techniques

POINT OF DATA REDUCTION: Because the aim of Case Study research is to closely & comprehensively study a specific unit of analysis, the researcher should examine all sources of information that were generated &/or interpreted in the present, as well as in the past

Organize data, notes, observations

Process, & summarize data (enter into computer, clean of error & bias, etc.)

Engage in **INTERDISCIPLINARY ANALYSIS** & synthesis

Articulate broad socio-historical process within which unit of analysis evolved

Interpret data & summarize findings

Determine meaning & implications of findings in relation to research concern/issue

Propose practical recommendations for addressing concern/issue & for future research

Report & present findings in document, publication, presentation, etc.

Assess implications of study, as well as lessons learned practically, theoretically, ethically, & methodologically

Develop policy/standards/guiding principles according to lessons learned